FIGHTERBASE

Halal

Diet guide

Islamic dietary law. No pork or alcohol; halal meat.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Halal**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Halal?

Food permitted under Islamic law. Meat must come from a halal source; pork, alcohol and blood are not permitted. Everything else can be built into any style.

Where it comes from

Halal means 'permitted' in Arabic. The rules come from the Qur'an and Islamic teaching. Pork and its products, alcohol, blood, carrion and animals not slaughtered in the prescribed way are forbidden (haram). Different schools and communities differ on some details.

The main ideas

1. No pork or anything made from pork (including gelatine and lard unless from a halal source).
2. No alcohol, including as a cooking ingredient or in extracts.
3. Meat and poultry must come from permitted animals slaughtered in the prescribed way.
4. Fish and seafood: most scholars allow fish; views on shellfish differ between schools.
5. Avoid cross-contamination with haram foods in cooking and serving.
6. Fasting in Ramadan changes eating times for a month.

Who it suits

- Muslims following halal rules
- People who want to cook for or eat with Muslim friends and teammates

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
> - You have a medical condition and are fasting in Ramadan
> - You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18 and fasting
> - You take medication that has to be taken with food or at set times

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Halal does not change sports nutrition: the same protein, carbs and fluids apply.
- Ramadan: aim to train after the evening meal (iftar) where you can, and put protein and carbs in both iftar and the pre-dawn meal (suhoor).
- Rehydrate steadily between iftar and suhoor.
- Many scholars allow exemptions from fasting for illness or travel. Follow your own guidance.

> Like any balanced diet. During Ramadan, training and eating times shift: many fighters train close to iftar and eat recovery meals at iftar and suhoor.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Protein
repair
Where: halal meat, fish, eggs, dairy, lentils, chickpeas

Iron
oxygen carrying
Where: halal red meat, lentils, spinach, dates

Vitamin D
bones and immunity
Where: oily fish, eggs, sunlight, supplement

Fluids and salt
hydration, especially in Ramadan
Where: water, soups, dates and salt at iftar

Common mistakes

- Assuming vegetarian foods are halal (they can contain alcohol or gelatine)
- Forgetting gelatine in sweets, yoghurts and supplements
- Trusting 'halal' on a menu without asking
- Skipping suhoor in Ramadan and training hungry

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Pork-derived or doubtful: gelatine (E441), lard, bacon, ham, pepsin
- Alcohol: wine, beer, vanilla extract, some flavourings
- Doubtful additives: E120 (carmine), E542, some emulsifiers (E471 can be animal or plant) - check the certification
- Look for a recognised halal certification mark

Eating out

- Ask if the meat is halal and how it is stored.
- Choose fish or vegetarian dishes when unsure.
- Check desserts for gelatine and alcohol.
- Ask about shared fryers and grills.

Easy swaps

Gelatine sweets	→	Pectin-based or halal-certified sweets
Wine in recipes	→	Grape juice, stock or vinegar (check your school's view)
Pork sausage	→	Halal chicken, beef or lamb sausage
Gelatine capsules	→	Vegetarian capsules or halal-certified

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Eggs, flatbread, labneh	Chicken wrap, salad	Lamb curry, rice, vegetables
Tue	Porridge, dates, milk	Tuna and sweetcorn sandwich	Grilled chicken, rice, salad
Wed	Foul medames and bread	Lentil soup, bread	Salmon, potatoes, greens
Thu	Omelette and toast	Chicken shawarma bowl	Beef kofta, hummus, rice
Fri	Yoghurt, fruit, nuts	Falafel wrap	Chicken biryani, raita
Sat	Pancakes with fruit	Leftover biryani	Fish stew, rice
Sun	Shakshuka, bread	Mixed grill, salad	Roast chicken, vegetables

Snacks

Dates and nuts · Fruit · Yoghurt · Hummus and vegetables · Boiled eggs · Halal jerky

Shopping list

Halal-certified meat and poultry · Fish and shellfish (per your school) · Eggs, dairy · Rice, bread, lentils, chickpeas · Dates, nuts · Spices · Halal-certified gelatine-free sweets

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Is all fish halal?

Most scholars say yes. Views on shellfish differ between schools: follow your own.

What about alcohol-based flavourings?

Many follow a strict rule and avoid them. Practice varies: follow your own scholar.

Can I take protein powder?

Check for gelatine, animal-derived enzymes and certification.

Further reading

Your local mosque or scholar; halal certification bodies in your country; British Dietetic Association guidance on fasting.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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